

04 - Iconography and Illustration Guidelines

[Iconography guide](#) | [Illustration system and prompt rules for future icons](#)

Formal name: Iconography guide

Icon style summary

Icons should feel like precise field-guide sketches: thin-line, slightly human, editorial, and useful. They should match the Wayfinder system, not generic app icons.

Core visual traits

- Stroke-based line icons, 1.5-2 px equivalent.
- Rounded joins and caps, but not bubbly.
- Mostly one color: Harbor Ink, Blueprint Blue, or Soft Iris.
- Optional soft background chip in Silver Fog.
- No 3D, gradients, neon, cartoon faces, or emoji styling.
- Use imperfect annotation marks sparingly: arrows, underlines, dotted paths.

Core icon set

Concept	Icon idea	Usage
Writing	Pencil / bookmark / page	Writing cards, Substack CTA
Projects	Code brackets / cube / terminal	Projects and GitHub cards
Now	Small compass / pulse dot	Current-focus modules
AI fluency	Node graph / small brain / spark	Capability cards
Product marketing	Target / signal cone / map pin	Credibility pillars
Culture	Music note / record / headphones	Listening Trail
Contact	Envelope / paper plane	CTA and footer
North	Compass rose + sprig	Mascot and guide notes

Prompt formula for future icons

Create a minimal editorial line icon for [CONCEPT]. Style: hand-drawn field-guide line art, thin navy stroke, slight human irregularity, rounded caps, simple silhouette, no fill except optional pale blue background chip, no gradients, no 3D, no cartoon face, no emoji. It should fit Darwin Hernandez's Wayfinder identity: compass, contour lines, annotations, practical intelligence, cultural taste.

Example prompts

1. Create a minimal editorial line icon for "AI workflow" using a small node graph connected to a compass point. Thin navy stroke, slight hand-drawn irregularity, no fill, transparent background.
2. Create a minimal editorial line icon for "Substack essay" using a bookmark, page, and small annotation underline. Thin navy stroke with one soft iris accent.
3. Create a minimal editorial line icon for "GitHub project" using a terminal window and small route line. Thin navy stroke, no logo copying, no 3D.

Do / do not

Do	Do not
Use consistent stroke weight	Mix filled icons with line icons
Use North marks as accents	Put North everywhere
Create SVG icons when possible	Use raster icons for UI primitives
Use accessible labels	Rely on icons without text
Keep icons calm	Use playful startup mascots